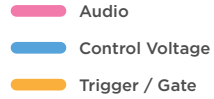
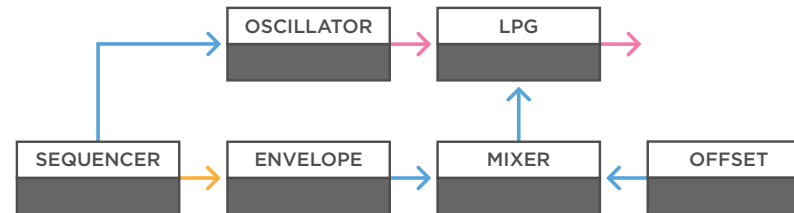


Dual Low Pass Gate Voice



MONOTRAIL TECH TALK



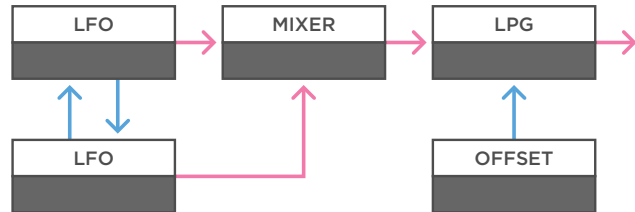
(a)

a - The Low Pass Gate is very suitable to patch up a compact modular voice. Simply use an oscillator and send it to a Low Pass Gate to shape the sound. You can mix the output in the modular, or send it directly to an outboard mixer.

In order to control the Gate, you can use a combination of a mixer, offset voltage, and envelope with attenuator. Then, just add a sequencer to sequence the oscillator, and trigger the envelope, to finish the fully functional voice.

Dual Low Pass Gate Voice

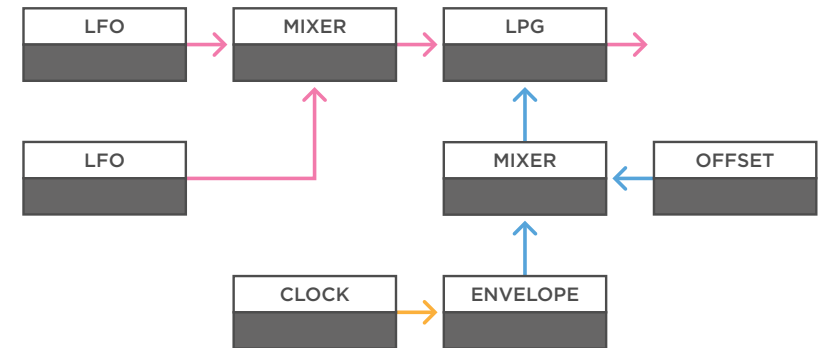
- Audio
- Control Voltage
- Trigger / Gate



(a)

a - A gate also works great for drones. For example, during the opening of your set, you can use two LFO's that are capable of going into audio rate, and have them modulate each other to create an interesting drone. Mix them together, and send the result into the LPG to tame the sound. Again, use an offset voltage to manually open the gate.

MONOTRAIL TECH TALK



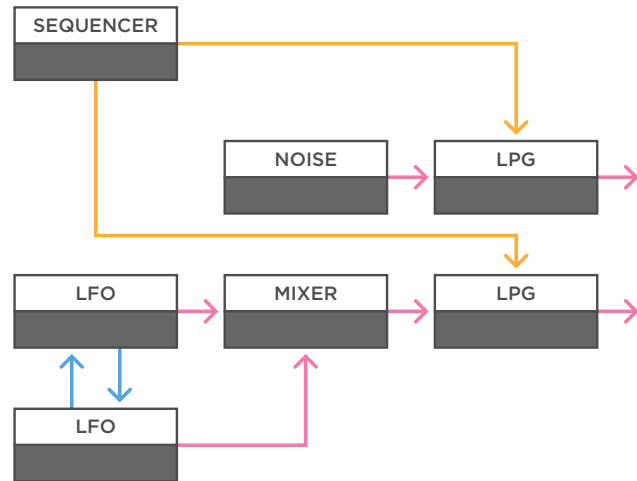
(b)

b - Gates work really well on more complex FM sounds if you use some modulation. You can add an envelope triggered by a steady clock to the previous setup, to turn the drone into a more percussive rhythmic sound. From there you can start adding other voices or percussion to build up a track.

Dual Low Pass Gate

Percussion

— Audio
— Control Voltage
— Trigger / Gate

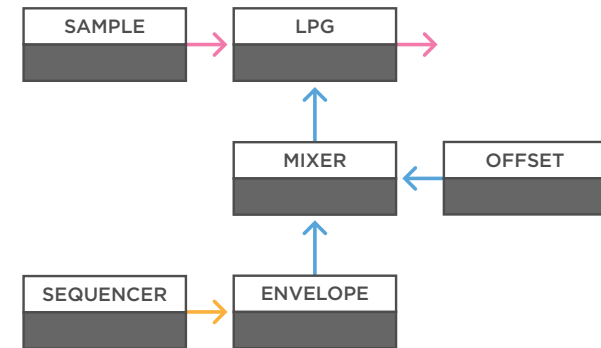


(a)

a - A dual Gate is extremely useful for percussive sounds. A simple example is to feed white noise into a gate to create a hat sound. But you can feed a Gate anything you like. For example the sound of the two cross modulating LFO's used earlier. Then, use a trigger sequencer to trigger the strike inputs of the Gates, and you have the start of a percussive section.

MONOTRAIL

TECH TALK



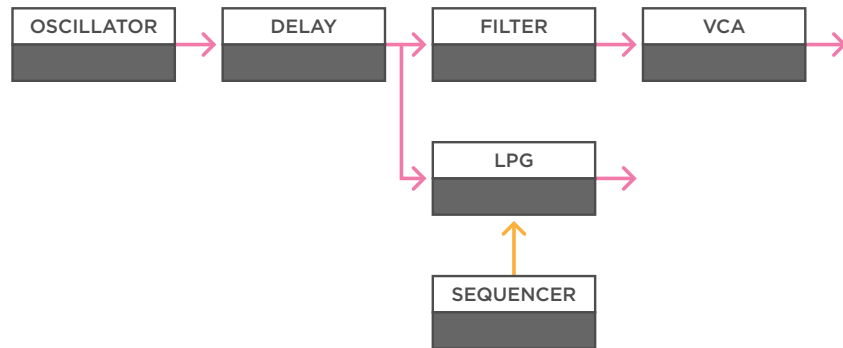
(b)

b - If you want more control over the length of a percussive sound, simply trigger an envelope again, and have that open the gate, instead of using the strike input. When you feed the Gate a long noisy sample, and use a mixer that can attenuvert, and offset, you can easily change the sound from a plucky percussive sound, to a side chained background sample.

Dual Low Pass Gate

Percussion

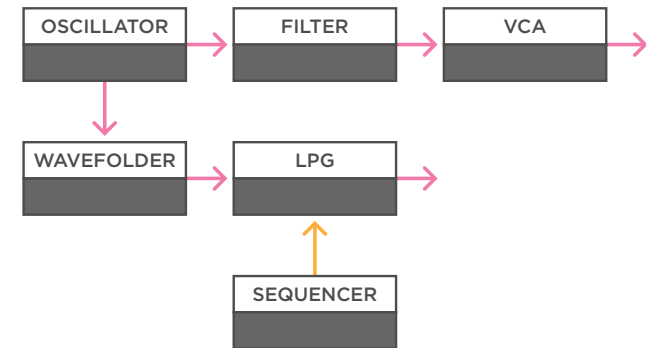
Audio
Control Voltage
Trigger / Gate



(a)

a - Another trick to add percussive texture to your track without a lot of extra modules is to tap a sound from an existing voice. The voice you see here is one of the main voices in my life sets. A single saw wave oscillator is fed into a fast delay to create a stacked oscillator effect. That sound is fed into a filter and then a VCA. When you multiply the audio signal from that voice, before going into the filter, and send it to the gate, you can create an independent percussive sound related to that voice. Just send a trigger to the strike input.

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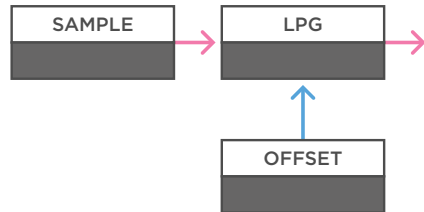
(b)

b - Another example is a voice based on a wavetable oscillator. I like to use the Erica synths black wavetable oscillator, which has both a regular and sub output. That gives you the possibility to tune your percussive sound one or two octaves above or below the voice. You can even spice up the percussive signal by sending it to something like a wavefolder before going into the gate.

Dual Low Pass Gate

Amplitude & Frequency Control

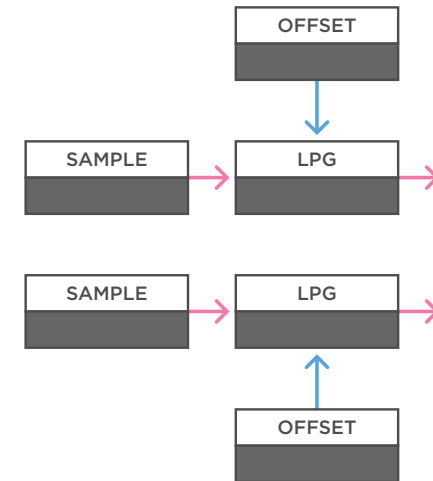
Audio
Control Voltage
Trigger / Gate



(a)

a - A LPG is also a powerful tool to control the frequency and amplitude of a signal. For example, it works great to shape the sound of a background sample. Just feed the gate a looping field recording and use an offset to manually roll off the high end. Both with samples, as well as percussive sounds, it's useful to use an outboard mixer to remove the low end of a sound as well. This gives more clarity in a mix, and the possibility to place a sample or hat sound in the frequency spectrum, right where you want it.

MONOTRAIL TECH TALK



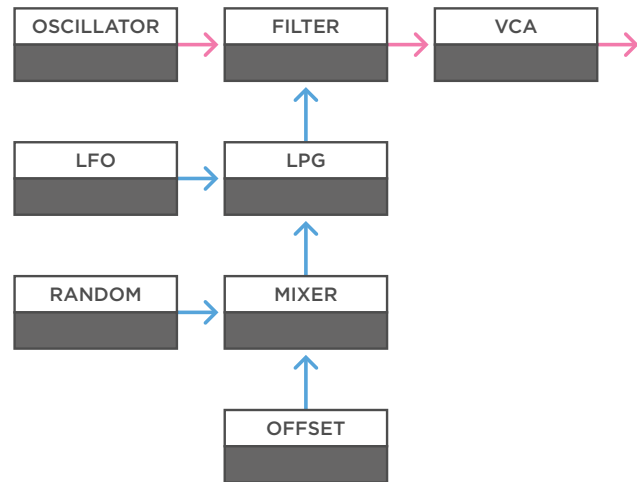
(b)

b - This trick also works great on drums. You can use a dual sample player to both play a steady kick, as well as different sequenced percussive hits. Send each of those into a separate gate, and use offset voltages to manually open and close the gates. This gives you the possibility to have those sounds come up from a soft dark sound, to a bright in your face sound with full transients. Especially for the kick drum, this adds a lot of performance dynamics to a steady sample.

Dual Low Pass Gate

VCA for control voltages

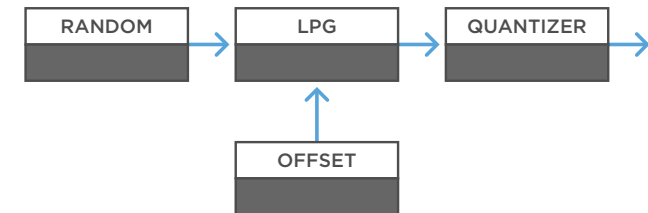
Audio
Control Voltage
Trigger / Gate



(a)

a - A Low Pass Gate can also be used as a VCA for control voltages. For example send a square wave LFO into a Gate, before modulating a filter. Then just add a smooth random voltage and some offset again to open and close the gate, and have the amount of modulation change over time.

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(b)

b - Or, use the gate to control the amount of random voltage or noise going into a quantizer, to determine the spread of a randomly generated melody. Like with a regular VCA, the possibilities are endless.